

Research – UX Design Principles and Notes

Important principles to adhere to and how I plan to do that:

1. **User-Centricity:** putting users' needs first and making decisions based on what you know about them and what they want from the product:
 - a. Users are SecOps
 - b. SecOps wants an interface that is easy to use and doesn't differ immensely from AutoTask as they are all familiar with it and don't want to have to be taught a new system
 - c. My idea is to implement categorisation and organisation by displaying 'cards' and 'lists' inspired by Trello, wherein each list is an AI defined category and each ticket is a 'card'.
 - d. Clicking on a ticket will expand to an almost same looking interface that SecOps see– but removing or not prioritising the less important information about a ticket:

e.

The screenshot displays a ticket management system interface. At the top, a header bar shows the ticket title "TICKET - T20160902.0001 - I am unable to connect to the network again! (Harrison Law Firm)" and navigation options like "Edit", "Accept", "Forward", "Tools", and "Complete". Below the header, the left sidebar contains a navigation menu with sections: "Company" (Harrison Law Firm), "Contact" (Anthony Harrison), "Status" (Processing), "Priority" (Critical), "TICKET INFORMATION" (Issue Type: IT:Hardware, Sub-Issue Type: Network Device, Source: Client Portal, Due Date: 09/20/16 06:02 AM, Estimated Hours: 4h, Service Level Agreement: Standard for ALL), and "ASSIGNMENT" (Queue: IT: Level I, Primary Resource: Brody Terry, Secondary Resources: Scott Anderson, Harold Arnold).

The main content area is divided into several sections. The top section shows the ticket details: "STANDARD SERVICE REQUEST", "T20160902.0001", and a timer "23:59:00". The title "I am unable to connect to the network again!" is prominently displayed. Below the title, the "DESCRIPTION" section contains the text: "Connecting to the network has been spotty over the last few days. I was last able to connect this morning but have been having nothing but trouble since then. I'll need to regain access ASAP, please." The "TIMELINE" section shows a "FIRST RESPONSE" with a status of "SLA". The "RESOLUTION" section is currently empty.

On the right side, there are two panels. The "COMPANY/CONTACT" panel lists details for Harrison Law Firm, including address, phone numbers, and email. The "TIME SUMMARY" panel shows a progress bar for "Worked" (3h 7m) and "Estimated" (4h) time, with "53m Remaining". The "CONFIGURATION ITEM" panel lists details for a "Dell Optiplex 9010 (PC)", including contact information and installation date.

2. **Consistency:** keeping designs consistent in terms of how they look and function across all pages and screens, keeping consistency across visuals (buttons and links) and your tone:
- a. I plan to implement a dashboard/homepage which will be the 1st page the site opens on. The homepage will display 'quick' and urgent information, quick stats about work progress.
 - b. A table will be featured in the middle of the page which will show all the tickets marked with HIGH Priority that are due that day.
 - c. To keep consistency across the pages, I can:
 - i. integrate soft rounded corners as opposed to the 2D and sharp rectangles,
 - ii. Make sections about the ticket on the side panel of a ticket appear like lists from the previous page, which each attribute mimicking the appearance of a card.

3. **Hierarchy:** relates to both information architecture and visual architecture.

InfoArch– the sitemap, overall structure and organisation of the website and how the user will navigate from one page to another. VisualArch– how elements are laid out on the screen:

- a. For navigation, I plan to implement a navbar to the side (1st design was on the left, 2nd design was on the right) which has a home icon for the homepage, and icons for all active tickets and closed tickets, as well as a user icon for the account at the bottom.
- b. I also plan to show the Breadcrumb at the top of a page underneath the company name and logo header, so it is easy to see where you came from.
- c. For VisualArch, I plan to show tickets needing immediate attention with a read header for urgency and to draw attention, placed in the middle as it is usually where the eyes go first.
- d. Different font sizes for headings and subheadings.
- e. Again, putting less needed/less regarded by SecOps information towards the bottom.
- f. Only showing the immediate information about a ticket needed at hand on the 'card' of a ticket, the rest will be shown upon clicking, which takes you to a new page.

4. **Context:** understanding who the users are and in what context they will be using the website, what factors may impact user experience:
 - a. SecOps are a small team but very busy, very swamped as they receive a large load of tickets
 - b. Tickets have priorities set to them as well as due dates, meaning they usually have to be working a lot and very quickly
 - c. Therefore, it is important to show them only what is necessary so they have the knowledge they need at first glance.
 - d. Hence, I re-affirm my ideas on InfoArch & VisualArch.
5. **User Control:** giving the user the right amount of control over how they interact with a product, as they often perform unwanted actions and need a 'clearly marked emergency exit'. ***NOTE: This is especially true with AI automation, and there needs to be a balance between AI and user control. Users should be able to override AI decisions.***
 - a. Considering we have AI sorting and categorising the tickets, it's possible it makes a wrong decision.
 - b. I plan to put an ellipsis menu for each ticket in the categorised lists in case SecOps notices something wrong, they can assign a new category which will be done via modal.
6. **Accessibility:** ensuring the website is accessible to and usable for as many people as possible, catering to the needs of people with disabilities.
 - a. I plan to use clear and plain language throughout the site
 - b. Implement a clear and semantic HTML design
7. **Usability:** learnability, efficiency, memorability, errors, satisfaction:
 - a. Providing quick navigation and all the necessary information.

Reference list

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